Red kangaroo reproduction

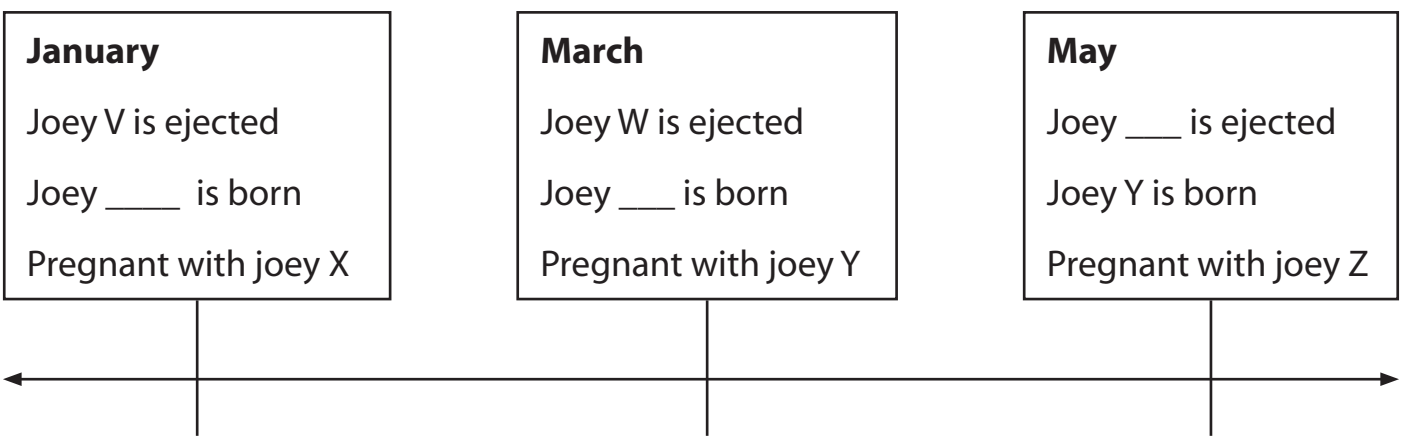
Word bank

nipples
first
reproductive
stage
weighs
joey
pouch
drink
different
ejected
pregnant
development
droughts
feeding

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

The female red kangaroo has three stages to her r_____ cycle. The f_____ stage is mating. The pregnancy lasts 33 days, but d_____ may stop for months without any harm to the foetus. The second s_____ is birth. When the red kangaroo is **born** it is the size of a raisin and w_____ just under 1 gram. It crawls into the mother's p_____ and attaches itself to one of her n_____. The third stage is ejecting the j_____ from the pouch for good – although it may still tuck its head into her pouch for an occasional d_____. During d_____ a joey may be **ejected** before it reaches maturity. As soon as the joey has been e_____ the female mates straight away to make sure she is p_____ again. This means kangaroos are always **pregnant** and f_____ one joey, or even two at d_____ stages of development.

2 Look at the timeline below showing three cycles of pregnancy for a female red kangaroo. Fill in the blanks to show the stages for joeys V, W, X, Y and Z.



Months in the life of a female red kangaroo

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